

Council Meeting
September 10, 2025
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The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, September 10, 2025, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Girard at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne
Ward II Councilor Brian Zutter
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Hayden
Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor William Greenrose
At-Large Councilor Wayne Hemingway
At-Large Councilor William Limoges
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Mayor Dale Girard

Also present:

Nancy Bates, Interim City Manager

AGENDA CHANGES

Mayor Girard noted there are two changes, the Council is removing item A and B to the September 24th Council Meeting to allow the public to get to the School Board meeting tonight.

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Zutter to accept the minutes of the August 27, 2025, City Council meeting.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – abstain

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-0, 1 abstain

MAYOR'S NOTES

Mayor Girard noted the City Election filling period is open September 17th to the 26th. The Clerks office will be open on Friday afternoon from 3p-5p.

The Claremont School Board has a current vacancy and are accepting letters of interest from the current registered voters in Claremont and would need to be submitted to the School Office by next Monday September 15th by 3:30pm.

Kiwanis Brewfest will be Saturday September 20th at the Visitors Center Green.

Parks and Recreation will host a fall festival and Chili Cook off from 10am-3pm on October 4th on the Visitors Center Green.

CITY MANAGER'S REPORT

Manager Bates noted the Washington Street paving project is complete and drive/walk through inspection will be happening soon.

North and Main Street project is on track for base painting.

17 Water Street completed the Purchase and Sale Agreement last week, and the City should receive its first deposit this week.

The final approved budget book is finished and will be sent to the printers soon.

Currently three candidates for the Planning and Development Director position and is hoping to make an offer next week.

There is Health Trust public hearing on September 25th in Concord to discuss rate settings for the next plan year and determine surplus for coverage lines, times are to be determined.

APPOINTMENT TO BOARDS AND COMMITTEES

Steering Committee for EPA Multi-Purpose Grant

By consensus Council agrees putting the appointment off until there is a recommendation from the Planning Board.

Tolles Home Resignation

A motion was made by Councilor O’Hearne and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to accept resignation from the Tolles Home Board from Jamie De Rosa.

Voice vote:

Koloski – no

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 8-1

CITIZEN’S FORUM

Mayor Girard gave reminder that Citizen’s forum is designed to allow you the opportunity to make the Council aware of your concerns. Please state your name and ward number, we ask you to address your concerns directly to the Council. The Council Manager will not be responding to you during this time. You are limited to five minutes on any non-agenda items. In the back of the room please write down your contact information if you’d like to be contacted as well as your concern on the clipboard for follow-up.

Joel Hass, from Gilmanton, Mayor Girard noted Citizen’s forum was for Claremont Residents.

OLD BUSINESS

Ordinance 640 Merit System Amendment to Attachment B Payroll and Human Resources Specialist [Part Time] – Third and Final Reading – Public Hearing

Shannon Thibodeau, Human Resource Director explained the position and is requesting approval of this part time position.

CITY OF CLAREMONT - IN THE YEAR TWO THOUSAND AND TWENTY-FIVE

ORDINANCE #640

Amending the City of Claremont's Merit System – Modification of Grade Classification for Creation of Position of Part-Time Payroll and Human Resources Specialist and Revocation/Replacement of Position of Finance/Human Resources Specialist with Position of Accounting Specialist; Amending the Non-Union Employee Classification Plan

THE CITY OF CLAREMONT ORDAINS:

Pursuant to Article III, Sections 24, 25 and Article IV, Sections 51 and 52, of the Claremont City Charter; the City's Merit System as well as the Non-Union Employee Classification Plan (Attachment B) are hereby amended and readopted as follows:

Section 1. New Position and Compensation Grade for Part-Time Payroll and Human Resources Specialist

A new employment position titled, Part-Time Payroll and Human Resources Specialist, shall be hereby established within the City's Merit System as well as the Non-Union Employee Classification Plan (Attachment B). The rate of compensation to be paid to this position shall be established by such Grade, as provided below, from which the salary range of this position is identified within the Non-Union Employee Pay Schedule at the annualized pay scales as set forth in Attachment C (on file in the City Manager's Office):

Position:

Grade:

Part-Time Payroll and Human Resources Specialist

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Section 2. Revocation/Replacement of Position of Finance/Human Resources Specialist as well as Creation of New Position and Compensation Grade for Accounting Specialist

A new employment position titled, Accounting Specialist, shall be hereby established within the City's Merit System as well as the Non-Union Employee Classification Plan (Attachment B). Contemporaneously with the creation of this new position, the position of Finance/Human Resources Specialist shall be terminated and removed from the City's Merit System as well as the Non-Union Employee Classification Plan (Attachment B). The rate of compensation to be paid to this position (Accounting Specialist) shall be established by such Grade, as provided below, from which the salary range of this position is identified within the Non-Union Employee Pay Schedule at the annualized pay scales as set forth in Attachment C (on file in the City Manager's Office):

Position:

Grade:

Accounting Specialist

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Section 3. Non-Union Employee Classification Plan

The compensation of every non-union employee of the City shall be determined by the classification of the job in which such person is employed and in accordance with Attachments B and C to the City's Merit System (which are on file in the City Manager's Office). Upon adoption of this Ordinance, the new version of the Non-Union Employee Classification Plan (Attachment B), which is an exhibit to this Ordinance, shall be implemented with the proposed changes contained therein and consistent with this legislative act.

Section 4. Prior Enactments Superseded

The Non-Union Employee Classification Plan as adopted by action of the City Council concerning those set forth in Attachment B, prior to adoption of this Ordinance and all prior amendments thereto, are hereby repealed as they pertain to same.

Section 5. Validity

If any article, section, subsection, sentence, clause or phrase of this Ordinance is for any reason held to be unconstitutional or invalid, such decision shall not affect the remaining portions of this Ordinance.

Section 6. Effective Date

This Ordinance shall take effect and be enforced immediately upon passage, but shall be retroactive to the first day of the month in which it is passed upon third reading.

A motion was made by Councilor Hayden and seconded by Councilor Koloski to pass Ordinance 640.

Councilor Hayden read explanation of proposed action into the record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Zutter – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

NEW BUSINESS

Issue Order to City Clerk for Placement of Proposed Charter Amendment

Motion to Issue Order to City Clerk for Placement of Proposed Charter Amendment on the Ballot for the November 4, 2025, Municipal Claremont, NH Election

The Claremont City Council hereby submits a proposed amendment to the City Charter that seeks to alter Part I, Article III, Section 27 in order to remove the residency requirement for any potential hire for City Manager. The amendment also proposes to eliminate all pronouns provided within same. These Council-approved changes, associated with this Charter amendment, are provided below:

PROPOSED AMENDMENT TO CITY CHARTER:

Part I, Article III, Section 27 - Qualifications

Current Version

- **27. - Qualifications.**

The manager shall be chosen solely on the basis of his/her executive and administrative qualifications, but he/she need not be a resident of the city or state at the time of his/her appointment. During his/her tenure of office, he/she shall reside within the city. To

avoid a conflict of interest, no person who has within two (2) years been elected by popular vote to any office in the City of Claremont shall be chosen manager.

Proposed Amendment to Section 27: The sentence “During his/her tenure of office, he/she shall reside within the city.” will be removed from the Charter. The pronouns will also be removed from this particular provision in the Charter.

- **27. - Qualifications.**

~~_____~~The manager shall be chosen solely on the basis of ~~his/her~~ executive and administrative qualifications, but ~~he/she~~ need not be a resident of the city or state at the time of ~~his/her~~ appointment. ~~During his/her tenure of office, he/she shall reside within the city.~~ To avoid a conflict of interest, no person who has within two (2) years been elected by popular vote to any office in the City of Claremont shall be chosen manager.

New Version with Amendment:

- **27. - Qualifications.**

The manager shall be chosen solely on the basis of executive and administrative qualifications, but need not be a resident of the city or state at the time of appointment. To avoid a conflict of interest, no person who has within two (2) years been elected by popular vote to any office in the city of Claremont shall be chosen manager.

* * *

The Claremont City Council’s approval of this Motion shall constitute the “order” in accordance with N.H. RSA §49-B:5. The Council hereby orders as well as authorizes the City Clerk to undertake any necessary actions or statutory obligations to effectuate the placement of

this proposed amendment to the City's Charter on the ballot for the November 4, 2025 Claremont New Hampshire Municipal election.

Councilor Koloski shared concern for what the question on the ballot will look like and wants this information.

A motion was made by Councilor O'Hearne and seconded by Councilor Limoges to Issue Order to City Clerk for Placement of Proposed Charter Amendment on the Ballot for November 4, 2025, Municipal Claremont, NH Election, and to send council what the actual ballot question will read.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O'Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Resolution 2026-15 Highway Safety Grant – Public Hearing

Manager Bates read Chief Wilmot's memo explaining request for the highway safety grant.

RESOLUTION 2026-15

NEW HAMPSHIRE HIGHWAY SAFETY GRANT

BE IT RESOLVED by the Claremont City Council, after a public hearing duly noticed, that:

WHEREAS the City of Claremont, New Hampshire has applied for and been awarded a New Hampshire Highway Safety Grant for various motor vehicle enforcement activities, and speed-related equipment in the amount of \$8,500 for the period ending September 30, 2026; and

WHEREAS, if accepted, the City of Claremont, New Hampshire would have a \$2,125 matching requirement, all of which could be from in-kind funding, so it will have no impact on the tax rate; and

WHEREAS the City would like to accept and expend the funds for their intended purpose;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED that the City Council hereby authorizes the City Manager or her designees to undertake all actions and execute all documents as may be required to accept the Highway Safety Grant Funds in the amount of \$8,500 from the NH Highway Safety Agency for the purpose of motor vehicle enforcement; and

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED that the City Manager or her designees are hereby authorized to execute all documents and undertake all actions as may be required to implement this resolution.
(2/3 Vote Required)

Dated this 10th day of September, 2025 the City of Claremont, County of Sullivan, State of New Hampshire.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor O’Hearne to accept Resolution 2026-15.

Councilor Koloski read Resolution 2026-15 into the record.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

COMMITTEE REPORTS

Councilor Limoges noted the CDA had conversations about 56 Opera House.

Assistant Mayor Matteau noted the Planning Board did a site plan review on a multi-unit project on Central Street which has been cleared and is now starting the renovations.

Councilor Hemingway noted the Zoning Board did a walkthrough of 32 Lafayette Street to turn into storage unit, which was approved and discussed a variance for residential densities which needed more information.

Councilor O’Hearne reported the Tolles Home Site manager starts on Friday.

Councilor Greenrose stated the Historic District Commission met briefly over Grace River updating their signage which was approved.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

None.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None.

ADJOURNMENT

At 6:52 p.m., a motion was made by Councilor O’Hearne and seconded by Councilor Limoges to adjourn.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Julia A. Bizzarro
Clerk to the Council